

Chapter 10: Ancient India: Cultural

Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers

1. Answer in one sentence:

Q1.) Make a list of ancient Indian universities.

Renowned ancient Indian universities included **Takshashila, Varanasi, Valabhi, Nalanda, Vikramashila, and Kanchi.**

Q2.) Make a list of the Indian goods that were in demand in foreign countries.

Indian commodities in high overseas demand included fine cotton and silk textiles, ivory artifacts, pearls, precious gemstones, exotic spices (such as black pepper), and exquisitely decorated terracotta pottery.

2. Name the following:

Q1.) Epics and poetic compositions of ancient India.

The Arsha epics *Ramayana* and *Mahabharata*, the Tamil Sangam epics *Silappadikaram* and *Manimekalai*, and poetic works like *Paumachariya* (by Vimalasuri) and the kavyas of Kalidasa.

3. Fill in the blanks:

Q1.) The epic Ramayana was composed by rishi _____

(b) Valmiki

Q2.) The science of Indian medicine is called _____

(a) Ayurveda

Q3.) Thousands of students could live at the _____ University.

(c) Nalanda

4. Answer in brief:

Q1.) Explain what is meant by 'Tipitaka'.

Tipitaka (meaning 'Three Baskets') is the foundational sacred canonical scripture of Buddhism composed in the Pali language. It comprises three sections:

1. **Sutta Pitaka:** Contains the discourses and ethical teachings delivered by Gautam Buddha.
2. **Vinaya Pitaka:** Prescribes the rules of conduct and discipline for Buddhist monks and nuns (bhikkhus and bhikkhunis) in the Sangha.
3. **Abhidhamma Pitaka:** Philosophical exposition and deep analysis of Buddhist doctrine.

Q2.) What is the message of the Bhagwad Gita?

1. The Bhagwad Gita teaches the principle of *Nishkama Karma*: one must perform one's righteous duty without attachment or desire for selfish fruits/rewards.
2. It affirms that the path of spiritual liberation and devotion to the Divine (Bhakti) is equally accessible to every human being, transcending caste, gender, or social status.

Q3.) What aspects does Ayurveda take into account?

Ayurveda, ancient India's holistic medical tradition, encompasses the diagnosis of ailments, study of symptoms, clinical treatments, and pharmacology, while placing equal emphasis on healthy lifestyle, balanced diet, and the prevention of diseases.

Q4.) What is meant by Sangham Literature?

Sangham refers to ancient assemblies or academies of learned Tamil poets, scholars, and literati that met under royal patronage (particularly in Madurai). The rich anthology of poetry, folklore, and epic literature composed and compiled at these gatherings is known as Sangham literature.

5. Discuss:

Q1.) Art and architecture of the Mauryan and Gupta period.

1. During the Mauryan period, Indian stone architecture attained great mastery. Monolithic polished sandstone pillars erected by Ashoka, topped with exquisitely carved animal capitals, set unprecedented artistic standards.
2. The Gupta period represented the Classical Golden Age of Indian art, characterized by elegant temple architecture, dynamic cave sculptures at Karla, Nashik, Ajanta, and Ellora, and peerless fresco mural paintings.

6. What would you do?

Q1.) How would you obtain information about Ayurvedic medicine and use it in your day to day life?

I would read authentic books on home remedies and consult certified Ayurvedic practitioners. In daily life, I would incorporate time-tested herbal treatments for common ailments (such as tulsi and ginger for cough/cold, turmeric milk for healing, and amla for immunity) and embrace healthy dinacharya (daily wellness routine).

Q2.) On a trip to a historical site, your friend writes his name on the structure.

I would politely intervene and stop my friend immediately. I would explain that these monuments were created with immense artistic devotion and effort centuries ago and represent our irreplaceable national heritage. Defacing them causes permanent damage, and it is our moral responsibility to preserve them intact for future generations.

7. Observe the picture of the stupa at Sanchi and obtain more information about it:

1. The Great Stupa at Sanchi (Madhya Pradesh) was originally commissioned by Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BCE and is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
2. It comprises a large hemispherical dome (anda) enshrining sacred Buddhist relics, crowned by a harmika and three-tiered umbrella (chhatra).
3. It is encircled by a stone balustrade (vedika) featuring four masterfully carved ornamental gateways (toranas) facing the four cardinal directions, depicting Jataka tales and events from Buddha's life.